



Amazon COVID-19 test approved

Amazon has got FDA authorization for its subsidiary, STS Lab Holdco's, COVID-19 test kit. <http://dgit.in/apr21-07>



FB, Uber, MS to reopen offices

Facebook, Uber, and Microsoft are planning to start bringing employees back to offices. <http://dgit.in/apr21-08>

through a peer-to-peer learning network, for both professional and personal growth. The youth are taught skills such as coding, public speaking, professional writing and art therapy among others. Skillgram also used to hold a biweekly "Career Samvad" on FB and Insta where industry experts discuss their career journeys and personal experiences, as a means of giving career advice to the youth. Additionally, while the youth may be aware of the skills that they lack, they might not be aware of the places where they can acquire those skills. The cofounders of Skillgram are Radhika Krishna, Vikash Kumar, and we spoke to Krishna to find out more about how Skillgram is helping the disadvantaged youth. One of the first questions we asked was how is Skillgram differentiating itself from other edutech platforms? "Skillgram's goal is to provide disadvantaged youths with professional work and life skills through gamification. Through our animated learning partners – "Jeetu", "Neetu" and "Ritu ma'am", we provide skills such as MS Excel, Word, Canva, Spoken English, Time Management, Travel Empowerment to name a few. Unlike other gamification apps in the market, we are targeting work and life based skills for youths between the ages of 16-30. Our USP includes content and context that is culturally relevant, access to content offline, leaderboards for progress check, guilt free screen time, in-built peer interaction, social and emotional learning, personalised mentorship and being affordable."

We then asked for more information on the gamification and the peer to peer system, Krishna told us, "We are using gamification as a means for youths to learn essential skills. Learners can choose from various skills to learn. Peer interaction will have a small aspect to our overall system where learners can challenge their peer to retake a skill, ask questions and gauge their progress on the basis of location, gender and age. For every 3 skills which are completed, learners will win a chance at free personalised mentorship in their choice industry area to guide

them with their future career pathway." When asked about the kind of courses being taught, Krishna said, "Our content will be created by us and will emphasise on essential professional work and life skills that are not taught to youths at the institute level. Learning in a fun and interactive way, students complete our courses, get certified and become job ready to work."

We then asked for more information on Career Samvad, "Career Samvad was a talkshow launched by LearnHub which ran for 5 episodes. Here we invited industry experts in various domains such as public policy, social activism, design research, industrial product design etc to talk to us on a 1:1 basis about their career journey and the potential trajectory to have a career in that field/sector. Our target audience included students between the ages of 18-23 along with their parents to explore alternative careers and set appropriate expectations for different pathways. Our career samvad was live streamed on Facebook and Instagram and then later uploaded on YouTube." Skillgram is now working towards launching an app. They are looking to collaborate with NGOs working with youth skilling and development, especially in remote areas.

SHARENT WANTS YOU TO RENT UNUSED STUFF

Sharent is all about bringing the sharing economy to India at scale. At times, people may have some unwanted stuff around, such as a piano, a pool table, an exercycle or a trampoline that they might not want to sell, but is not being used at the moment at the same time. Sharent allows lenders to monetise their unused assets, and borrowers to pay to use an item for a short period of time. The cofounders of Sharent are Pritam Bhattacharjee, Surya, Ripdaman Singh, Sagnik Mukherjee and we spoke to Bhattacharjee to understand how Sharent differentiates itself from others. "Sharent runs an asset light model which is highly scalable at little capital cost. Sharent utilises the existing capacity in

the ecosystem to facilitate peer-to-peer rental. Sharent's robust pricing model and highly optimised supply chain ensures that we can provide the lowest per day rental rates as compared to its competitors. Sharent's pricing starts at Rs. 4/ day which is the lowest in the industry. Sharent operates a peer-to-peer rental marketplace which allows customers to not only rent items, but also list and lend out their non-value adding assets. Our robust quality check process ensures that the quality of the product being rented out meets the industry standards. Additionally our protocols of background check ensures that illegally procured products are not listed on the platform." We then wanted to know more about how Sharent uses technologies, "The website is powered by a scalable cloud server integrated with a content delivery network to ensure that the load speed is less than 3 seconds to reduce the bounce rate. Additionally, our intelligent chat bot answers queries of the customers and provides opportunities for the backend team to chat on the go from their mobile phones, apart from providing information about the customers location, number of previous visits, etc. so that customized experiences can be provided. Sharent uses google analytics to gather information about its website visitors, their demographics, which page is visited the most, average session time, etc. Sharent also uses various marketing tools to gather information about the competitors and take informed decisions about them. Sharent also uses machine learning to understand a user's journey through the website to provide them options as per their needs." Finally, we asked about how Sharent is reducing wastage and overconsumption, "Sharent operates on the philosophy of efficient utilisation of resources which is a practice inculcated into the company as well as the business models. By spreading the philosophy of pay as per use and renting rather than buying we are promoting a culture which is against over consumption to combat the issue of wastage."